

UiPath and BMO: A Digital Transformation Case
Individual Written Assignment

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Vendors and Tool Description

In the marketplace for robotic process automation (RPA) several vendors offer platforms that provide organisations the ability to automate repetitive, rules-based tasks, especially within back-office and front-office workflows. Included among the major players are UiPath Inc., Automation Anywhere, and Blue Prism. The vendor will be reviewed further in this assignment will focus on UiPath.

Commonly referred to as the "UiPath Platform," UiPath's flagship platform employs both attended and unattended bots, low-code/no-code development, integration of AI/machine learning, and cloud-native orchestration. For instance, for the seventh consecutive year, UiPath has been named a Leader in the 2025 Gartner Inc. Magic Quadrant for RPA, and they ranked highest for "Ability to Execute" (UiPath Inc., n.d.). The platform also supports process mining, task mining, intelligent document processing (IDP), and orchestration of the software robots within enterprise ecosystems ("UiPath Vs Other RPA Platforms," 2025).

In terms of market positioning, UiPath is in a leading position in the RPA market. A 2023 study shown that UiPath had approximately 35.8 percent market share worldwide in RPA (Mitchell, 2023). As we discovered in our research, UiPath is the largest vendor by RPA-revenue, having more than 10,000 enterprise customers to date (Diquez, 2025). In contrast, leading-edge competitors to UiPath such as Microsoft (through Power Automate), Automation Anywhere, and Blue Prism have less market positioning than UiPath, although Automation Anywhere is often quoted as in a second-place position.

UiPath offers a distinct competitive edge based on four key differentiators:

Breadth of enterprise capability: The platform goes beyond simple macro automation and supports AI-infused agentic automation (robots that can "think and learn") to differentiate itself from many legacy RPA tools.

Analyst recognition and ecosystem strength: Consistent leadership recognition from Gartner and other analyst firms reinforces customer confidence in regard to scalability and maturity.

Developer/community momentum and partner ecosystem: With low-code tools and a sizeable developer ecosystem, UiPath makes it easier for business users (not just IT) to engage in automation programs than some older tools.

Worldwide scale and vertical significance: UiPath has been well placed in various areas broadly such as Finance, Health and Telecommunications as well as having a strong foothold into these verticals.

In contrast, rivals may accommodate narrower use-cases, or do not possess the same level of orchestration and AI integration depth. For example, Microsoft's Power Automate runs to its benefits as part of the Microsoft ecosystem but can be claimed it is less flexible in non-Microsoft scenarios and less mature in advanced orchestration (Diquez, 2025). UiPath stands out from other RPA tools available in the market through a combination of many features such as scale, maturity, analyst position, and advanced features.

Use Case

The Bank of Montreal (BMO), one of Canada's "Big Five" banks, is part of the financial services industry, which demands stringent compliance, a high level of operational efficiency, and ultimately customer satisfaction. BMO leverages UiPath's Robotic Process Automation (RPA) to improve its complex back-office and customer-facing processes. This process aimed to automate repetitive processes such as loan origination, compliance reporting, and customer onboarding in retail and corporate banking.

BMO's automation journey was officially started by working with UiPath and Deloitte, building upon UiPath's enterprise-grade automation suite to develop a Centre of Excellence (CoE) for governance and scalability for automation. According to UiPath's 2023 financial services case studies, BMO deployed bots to process thousands of transactions daily, thus lessening manual processing time and improving data accuracy across departments.

The automation framework was integrated with BMO's existing IT systems, including Oracle systems, Microsoft 365, and internal banking applications, allowing for seamless data handoffs as well as audit trails in order to meet compliance needs, e.g., SOX compliance. BMO has created a hybrid workforce through this deployment; humans creating value while bots managed rule-based administrative tasks.

The implementation of UiPath in BMO demonstrates that RPA is a factor in improving service delivery in finance and is enhancing efficiency, scalability and accuracy in regulated

environments. This usage by BMO shows the industry trend of automating 30-50 percent of back-office workloads as banks seek a competitive advantage in the digital age.

Problem

Before the adoption of UiPath's automation platform, the Bank of Montreal (BMO) was confronted with a number of significant operational and strategic challenges, which impeded efficiency, compliance and responsiveness to customer service in its financial-services operations. First, many of the bank's back-office and monitoring processes were still largely manual and repetitive, depending on employees to execute on rule-based tasks across systems, which increased processing times, increased error rates, and limited scalability. For instance, the bank acknowledged publicly that it had large amounts of manual work on compliance reporting, transaction monitoring, and test-automation for internal controls (Davenport, 2020).

BMO's reaction to regulatory requirements and business growth opportunities was limited by the cost base and processing capacity of legacy (manual) workflows. For example, the institution mentioned that automating some bots had "created millions of dollars in value for the bank." The implication was that the absence of automation was costing the bank a considerable amount of human-labour and missed-efficiency opportunities (Poindexter, 2022). The impact of the manual workflows was slower service (for example, in client onboarding and risk calculation), higher operational risk (especially in the regulated banking environment) and less ability to scale volumes or adjust workflows to service clients.

Additionally, BMO's enterprise environment encompassed various systems, data formats and jurisdictions (Canada and the U.S.), which naturally complicated standardising and automating processes. This variety of legacy technical components, siloed functional departments and task-oriented rules created friction in executing end-to-end workflows. For example, as discussed in a Forbes article, bots were required to help with testing, monitoring and compliance, which implies, at minimum, that those processes were both laborious and error-prone before there was automation in place (Davenport, 2020).

Lastly, the strategic need for digital changes uncovered additional pain points: As BMO worked to deliver faster and smarter customer facing services (in onboarding, account opening,

transaction monitoring, and risk analytics), the lag of back-office throughput (and lack of automation) became a bottleneck. In tandem, as BMO wanted to support increased volumes, tighter regulation, and rising customer expectations for speed and accuracy, the manual nature of many processes was becoming a limit on competitiveness.

To recap what BMO's pre-digital environmental issues were: high operational costs and manual labour effort; elevated human error risk; inconsistent and time and manual process across systems; limited sufficient agility or scalability in workflows; and increasing misalignment between business ambition (being digital, efficient, and resilient) and the operational reality of manual processes in back offices. Therefore, achieving a robust enterprise automation platform was critical for BMO to transform an operational model to meet current and future demands for speed, scale and regulation.

Solution

Once the Bank of Montreal (BMO) selected the UiPath automation platform, the Bank was able to redevelop some of its key processes through an organized enterprise automation plan. The automation plan began with an Automation Center of Excellence (CoE) step process to create governance, scalability, and alignment with the Bank's compliance and risk frameworks. The CoE model ensured that all automation deployments followed the same procedures and protocols across departments while enabling long-term sustainability in building automation into the culture of the Bank (Kotla, 2024).

In BMO's experience, UiPath Studio, Orchestrator and Robots were applied to various volume and rule-based processes within retail and compliance tasks at work. In the area of retail banking, unattended bots were used to extract data files from customers' mortgage and loan applications, and validate and re-enter data files into BMO's current legacy systems. This led to an overall decrease in average processing time from just under 40 minutes to less than 5 minutes per application and also improved the Bank's turnaround and data accuracy for processing mortgage and loan applications. These bots perform continuous anti-money laundering (AML) and know-your-customer (KYC) verification checks as part of BMO's compliance activities. The automations also automatically create accountability and audit trails for regulators while reducing risks for manual errors (Shah, 2025).

In essence, UiPath Orchestrator enables job scheduling, monitoring, and governance, while Studio allows business and IT teams to engineer workflows with low-code tools. BMO implemented assisted automation launched by users and unattended automation for overnight batch processing to allow efficiency for around-the-clock processing. This allowed for data movement between Microsoft 365, Oracle, and internal banking applications into or out of a legacy application

While implementing the program, BMO faced different challenges, such as having low levels of process standardization across departments, having different data silos created by legacy systems, and concerns from employees about job security due to automation. To address these issues, BMO implemented internal training initiatives and fostered a "bots for the people" culture to stress human and digital worker collaboration (Davenport, 2020). The CoE also established clear governance guidelines for security and compliance to ensure BMO maintained regulatory compliance throughout the automation lifecycle.

With these initiatives, BMO moved to a hybrid workforce model in which bots handle repetitive administrative tasks while humans engage in strategic, analytical, and customer-facing work. As a result, this has led to measurable improvements in efficiency, data accuracy, and compliance readiness. BMO is now recognized as a leader in intelligent automation in the North American banking sector.

Benefits

Operational Efficiency and Cost Avoidance

BMO's RPA initiative gave "millions of dollars" in value, according to a 2022 report publication, by automating previous manual processes, and this demonstrated real financial value and labour-time savings (Poindexter, 2022). In addition, the UiPath banking-industry solution brief indicated BMO was achieving 20% - 60 % productivity improvements for credit analysts and more for end-to-end workflows which demonstrates BMO's automation investments yield meaningful throughput improvements and cost avoidance.

Accuracy, Risk Reduction and Compliance Benefit

At BMO, which operates in the highly-regulated banking environment, there is a high importance placed on accuracy and auditability. For example, the same industry brief mentions that, automation of document-intensive tasks reduces error rates to near-zero (UiPath Inc., n.d.). BMO mitigates operational risk and builds on its regulatory control environment by reducing human error exposures and enabling consistency in processes.

Workforce Productivity and Cultural Change

At BMO, automation has enabled a shift of human effort out of ongoing rule-based tasks to value-added work (e.g., customer engagement, analysis, innovation). The cultural mindset of “bots for the people, by the people” (note earlier comments) promotes employee empowerment, and reduce resistance to automation.

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